

Strategic Deep Dive: Chipkins Puratos & The Generative AI Opportunity

1. Executive Strategic Synthesis

1.1 The Strategic Inflection Point

The South African bakery and patisserie sector stands at a critical juncture, characterized by a dualistic pressure: the relentless demand for operational efficiency in a resource-constrained economic environment, and the burgeoning consumer appetite for hyper-personalized, health-conscious, and sustainable food products. Chipkins Puratos, the preeminent joint venture between Bidcorp Food Africa and the Puratos Group, occupies a commanding position at this intersection.¹ However, the very attributes that define its dominance—a sprawling logistical footprint derived from Bidcorp and a deep, scientifically rigorous R&D heritage from Puratos—create a complex operational matrix that is ripe for, yet currently under-utilizing, the transformative power of Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI).

This comprehensive analysis posits that Chipkins Puratos is not merely a candidate for digital transformation but is structurally primed to become the industry's first "Cognitive Ingredient Partner." The organization possesses what many competitors lack: a massive, proprietary, and bifurcated dataset. On one hand, it holds the transactional, high-frequency logistics data of the Bidcorp network, offering a real-time pulse on *what* South Africa eats.³ On the other, it commands the predictive, qualitative, and sensory data of the Puratos *Taste Tomorrow* ecosystem, providing foresight into *why* they eat it.⁵ Currently, these data universes function largely in parallel. The strategic deployment of GenAI offers the mechanism to bridge them—transforming passive market reports into active, autonomous predictive engines that drive sales, streamline supply chains, and accelerate product innovation.

1.2 The "Glocal" Value Proposition

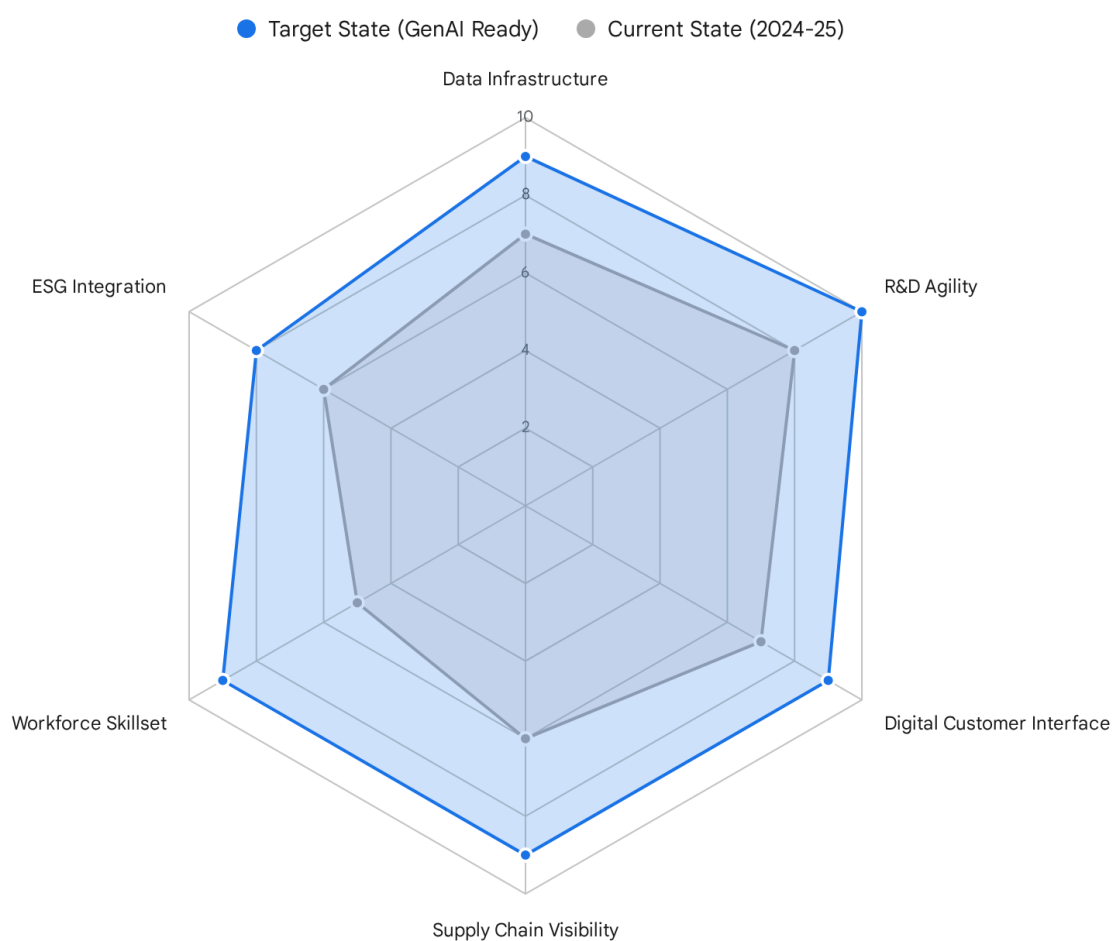
The central thesis of this report relies on the unique "Glocal" (Global-Local) nature of the Chipkins Puratos entity. As a 50/50 joint venture established in 2017, the company acts as a conduit, translating global Belgian innovation into the specific, often volatile context of the Southern African market.²

- **Global Intelligence:** Access to the Puratos Sourdough Library in Belgium, a repository of over 900 yeast strains⁸, and the *Taste Tomorrow* consumer insights platform¹⁰, grants the JV a predictive capability that local competitors cannot replicate.
- **Local Resilience:** Integration with Bidcorp's "Emerging Markets" division provides a defensive moat against the logistical chaos of the region, including port bottlenecks and

energy instability.³

The opportunity for GenAI lies in operationalizing this "Glocal" advantage. Where current processes rely on human intuition to adapt global recipes for local flour qualities or climate conditions, a GenAI model trained on the specific chemical parameters of South African ingredients could automate this localization, reducing time-to-market from months to weeks.

Chipkins Puratos: GenAI Strategic Readiness Assessment



Assessment of organizational readiness across key strategic pillars. While 'Market Position' and 'Data Availability' (via Taste Tomorrow/SAP) are high, 'AI Integration' and 'Hyper-Personalisation' represent significant growth opportunities.

Data sources: [MyPuratos](#), [Taste Tomorrow](#), [Puratos Careers](#), [Chipkins Puratos](#), [Bidcorp Annual Report 2024](#)

1.3 Critical Insights and Investment Thesis

The research underscores several high-impact insights that form the bedrock of the GenAI business case:

- **Asset Utilization:** The company has invested heavily in **8 Innovation Centers** across South Africa.¹¹ These centers are currently physical hubs of expertise. GenAI can digitize this expertise, creating a "Virtual Innovation Center" accessible to thousands of SME bakers who cannot physically visit a center, effectively scaling the value of the physical asset.
- **Data Latency:** While *MyPuratos* offers 24/7 ordering¹², the utilization of the data it generates is retrospective. The platform tells management what *was* sold. A GenAI-enabled layer could predict what *will* be needed, prompting customers to order before they realize they have a shortage, thereby protecting revenue against competitor incursion.
- **Supply Chain as a Service:** In an environment where Bidcorp reports "port bottlenecks" and "avian flu" impacts³, static supply chain planning is insufficient. GenAI offers the potential for dynamic scenario modeling—predicting the downstream impact of a cocoa shortage in West Africa on a specific chocolate muffin SKU in Bloemfontein three months later.

The following report details the operational, competitive, and technological landscape of Chipkins Puratos, culminating in a structured roadmap for integrating Generative AI to defend market share and unlock new value streams.

2. Corporate Genealogy & Governance Architecture

To effectively pitch strategic transformation to Chipkins Puratos, one must understand the distinct DNA of its two parent entities. The joint venture is not a seamless blend but a strategic tension between **efficiency** (Bidcorp) and **innovation** (Puratos). Successful GenAI initiatives must appeal to both instincts.

2.1 The Bidcorp Lineage: The Backbone of Efficiency

Bidcorp Food Africa, the local parent, acts as the operational spine of the joint venture. Listed on the JSE (Johannesburg Stock Exchange), Bidcorp is an international broad-line foodservice heavyweight. Its influence on Chipkins Puratos is evident in the relentless focus on logistics, margin management, and decentralized accountability.³

- **The "We Process" Strategy:** Within Bidcorp's strategic framework, Chipkins Puratos falls under the "We Process" pillar. This designation is crucial. It signifies a move beyond simple box-moving distribution into value-add light manufacturing. The strategy explicitly targets "transforming quality ingredients" into high-margin outputs like roasts, coats, and blends.¹⁴ GenAI applications that optimize yield, reduce waste in these processing lines, or improve the precision of "blends" directly support this strategic pillar.

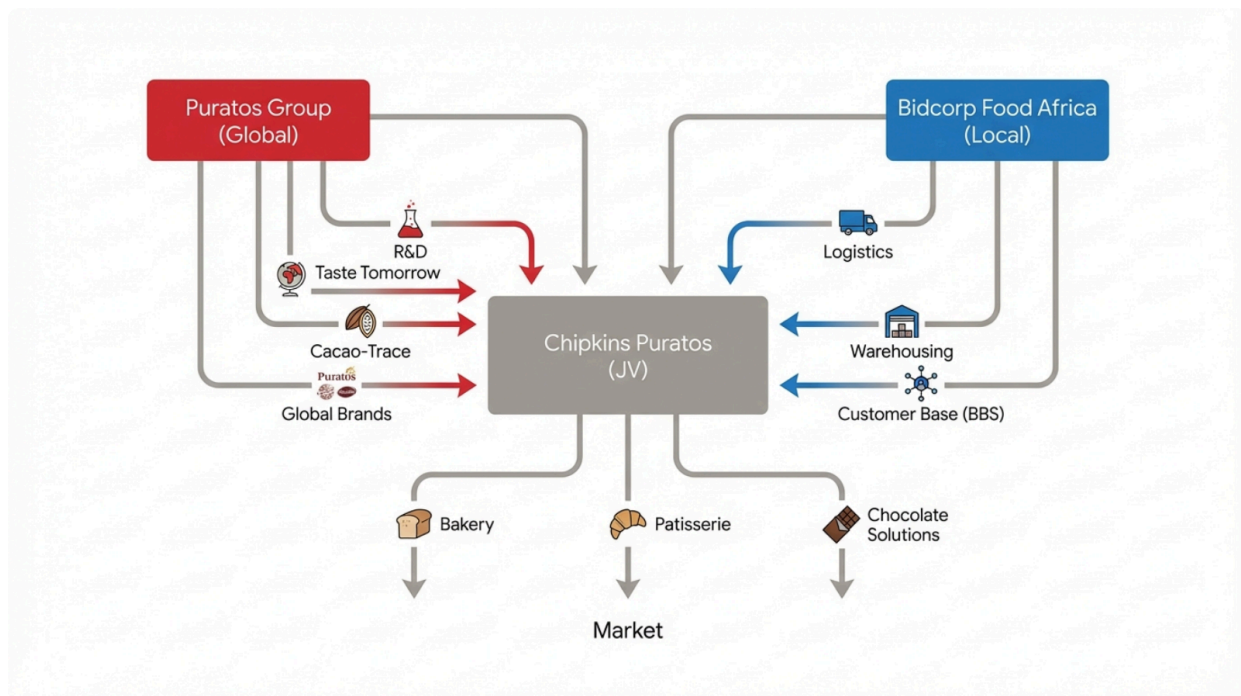
- **Decentralization as Dogma:** Bidcorp operates on a radically decentralized model. Each business unit is an autonomous entity empowered to make local decisions.¹⁵ This suggests that a monolithic, top-down AI implementation may face resistance. Instead, GenAI tools should be designed as modular capabilities that local managers can deploy to solve specific local problems (e.g., a pricing bot for the Cape Town branch, a stock predictor for the Durban warehouse).
- **Financial Resilience:** The "Emerging Markets" division, of which Chipkins Puratos is a key component, delivered "outstanding results" in F2024, with trading profits rising by 15.9% to R12.2 billion across the group.³ This financial health provides the necessary capital liquidity to invest in R&D and digital transformation, provided the Return on Investment (ROI) is clear and tangible.

2.2 The Puratos Lineage: The Engine of Innovation

If Bidcorp provides the body, Puratos provides the mind. Headquartered in Groot-Bijgaarden, Belgium, the Puratos Group is a century-old family-owned entity that prioritizes long-term vision over short-term quarterly results.²

- **R&D Intensity:** Puratos invests 2.2% of its global revenue into Research and Development, a figure significantly higher than the industry average for food distributors.¹⁸ It employs over 1,252 R&D researchers and technical advisors globally. For Chipkins Puratos, this connection provides access to deep scientific knowledge—enzyme hydrolysis, fermentation kinetics, and fat crystallization. GenAI is the only technology capable of ingesting this vast, complex scientific corpus and making it searchable and usable for a sales representative in Johannesburg.
- **Health & Well-being Mandate:** Under the leadership of Global CEO Pierre Tossut, Puratos has aggressively pursued a "Health & Well-being" agenda.²⁰ This includes sugar reduction, plant-based alternatives, and "clean label" products. GenAI can accelerate this mandate by using formulation algorithms to predict how removing an emulsifier or reducing sugar will affect the texture of a cake, drastically cutting down the physical trial-and-error phase.
- **Legacy and Continuity:** The appointment of Cédric Van Belle as Chairman underscores the family-led continuity of the group.²¹ This ownership structure values *legacy* and *sustainability*. AI proposals framed around "preserving institutional knowledge" or "ensuring the future of artisanal baking" align perfectly with this ethos.

The Chipkins Puratos Joint Venture Ecosystem



Operational synergy: Bidcorp contributes the logistical backbone and local market access, while Puratos injects R&D capabilities, global brands, and proprietary consumer insights.

2.3 The Joint Venture Dynamics

The operational reality of Chipkins Puratos is defined by the synthesis of these two cultures.

- **Governance Structure:** The board is composed of representatives from both parent companies to ensure consensus. Key figures include Nigel Phillips (CEO of Chipkins Puratos South Africa), who manages the execution, and Ryan Licht (CEO of Bidcorp Food Africa), who ensures alignment with the broader Bidcorp ecosystem.²²
- **Strategic Alignment:** The prompt execution of the JV agreement in 2017 was driven by a shared desire to capture the "booming African market".⁷ Bidcorp needed the technical products to fill its trucks; Puratos needed the trucks to deliver its technical products. The success of this synergy is evident in the carrying value of the investment, which stands at R465.4 million¹⁴, a significant asset on the Bidcorp balance sheet.
- **Digital Implication:** Any GenAI system implemented at Chipkins Puratos must be interoperable. It must feed data into Bidcorp's financial reporting systems while simultaneously pulling product data from Puratos's global PIM (Product Information Management) systems. A siloed solution that only serves one master will likely fail to gain board approval.

3. The South African Macro-Operational Context

Chipkins Puratos does not operate in a vacuum. The South African macroeconomic and operational landscape is uniquely challenging, shaping the company's immediate priorities. A GenAI strategy that does not explicitly address these local realities—specifically infrastructure reliability and economic pressure—will be dismissed as "ivory tower" thinking.

3.1 The Infrastructure Deficit: Power and Logistics

The most visceral challenge facing any South African manufacturer is the reliability of core infrastructure.

- **Energy Insecurity (Load-shedding):** The Bidcorp annual reports repeatedly cite "load-shedding" (periodic rolling blackouts) as a material operational constraint.³ For a bakery ingredients manufacturer, power cuts are disastrous. They disrupt continuous manufacturing processes (e.g., chocolate tempering or spray drying), leading to product waste and inconsistent quality.
 - *Strategic Implication:* While Chipkins Puratos has invested in solar energy to mitigate this¹, GenAI can offer **predictive energy management**. By correlating production schedules with national load-shedding forecasts (which are often available via API), an AI system could optimize production windows to ensure high-energy processes occur during stable power periods or peak solar generation hours.
- **Logistical Bottlenecks:** "Port bottlenecks" and delays at Transnet facilities have resulted in shortages of key imported products.³ Ingredients like specialized cocoa powders or proprietary enzymes, often imported from Puratos Belgium, are vulnerable.
 - *Strategic Implication:* The current "Just-in-Time" inventory models are risky in this environment. GenAI enables **"Just-in-Case" dynamic buffering**. An AI model can track global shipping data, port congestion indices, and local consumption rates to dynamically adjust safety stock levels for critical imported SKUs, ensuring continuity of supply without bloating working capital across the board.

3.2 Economic Pressures and the "Value" Consumer

The South African consumer is under immense pressure. High interest rates, unemployment, and food inflation have constrained disposable income.³

- **The Shift to Value:** There is a distinct bifurcation in the market. While the premium segment remains, the mass market is trading down to more affordable staples. The "standard loaf" remains king, but margins are thin.²⁵
- **Input Cost Volatility:** The cost of wheat, sugar, and energy has been volatile. Although inflation eased somewhat in F2024, the underlying cost base remains high.³
- **Competitive Response:** Manufacturers are focusing on cost containment and productivity. Chipkins Puratos must help its customers (the bakers) produce cheaper

bread without sacrificing quality. This is a chemistry problem. GenAI can assist in **Formulation Optimization**—finding the precise ratio of enzymes that allows a baker to use lower-protein (cheaper) local wheat while still achieving the volume and texture of a premium loaf.

3.3 The Competitive Landscape

The market for bakery ingredients in South Africa is concentrated and fiercely competitive. Chipkins Puratos fights for market share against vertically integrated giants.

- **RCL Foods:** A formidable competitor with deep vertical integration. They own the sugar mills (Selati) and the flour mills (Supreme), giving them a cost advantage in basic commodities.²⁷ They are aggressive on price for bulk ingredients.
- **Premier FMCG:** Another vertically integrated player (Snowflake flour, Blue Ribbon bread) with a massive footprint in both milling and baking.²⁷
- **Anchor Yeast:** A focused competitor in the fermentation space. While smaller in overall scope, they command strong brand loyalty in the yeast category and compete directly with Puratos's biotechnology offerings.³⁰
- **Tiger Brands:** The largest food company in the country, with immense marketing muscle and distribution reach.²⁷

The Chipkins Puratos Differentiator: Unlike RCL or Tiger Brands, which are primarily *commodity* movers or finished goods manufacturers, Chipkins Puratos positions itself as a *solution provider*. They do not just sell flour; they sell the "Soft'r Alpaga" improver that makes the flour perform better.³³ They sell the "Sunset Glaze" that replaces eggs.³⁴

- **GenAI Advantage:** This "solution" positioning is intangible and knowledge-heavy. GenAI allows Chipkins Puratos to scale this knowledge. While RCL competes on the price of sugar, Chipkins Puratos can compete on the *intelligence* of the application, using AI to help the baker use that sugar more effectively.

4. Operational Anatomy: Manufacturing & Innovation

To implement GenAI effectively, one must understand the physical assets it will optimize. Chipkins Puratos operates a sophisticated network of manufacturing and innovation nodes.

4.1 Manufacturing Capabilities: The "Wet and Dry" Matrix

The manufacturing footprint is divided into "wet" and "dry" lines, a distinction that fundamentally alters supply chain requirements.³⁵

- **Dry Manufacturing:** This involves the blending of powders—bread premixes, cake mixes, improvers, and enzymes.³⁶
 - *Operational Characteristic:* High volume, lower sensitivity to spoilage, but highly

- sensitive to recipe precision and raw material (commodity) costs.
- *AI Use Case: **yield optimization algorithms*** that analyze the exact chemical composition of incoming flour batches (which vary by harvest) and dynamically adjust the enzyme dosage in the premix to ensure consistent end-product performance.
- **Wet Manufacturing:** This includes the production of fruit fillings (Topfil), glazes (Sunset Glaze), and icings.³³
 - *Operational Characteristic:* High sensitivity to spoilage, temperature control, and hygiene. Requires cold chain logistics.
 - *AI Use Case: **Predictive Quality Control*** using computer vision sensors on the production line to detect viscosity changes or color variations in fruit fillings in real-time, reducing waste batches.

4.2 The Innovation Network: A Physical Moat

Chipkins Puratos's most significant competitive advantage is its network of **8 Innovation Centers** spread across South Africa.¹¹

- **Function:** These are not just test kitchens; they are co-creation hubs where industrial and artisanal customers come to develop new products using Puratos ingredients. They are equipped with industrial ovens, mixers, and sensory analysis tools.³⁴
- **Geographic Reach:** The centers are strategically located in major economic hubs including Johannesburg (Edenvale HQ), Cape Town (Montague Gardens), Durban, and Bloemfontein.³⁸ This geographical spread mirrors the Bidcorp distribution footprint, ensuring that technical support is never far from the customer.
- **The Sourdough Connection:** Through the global network, these local centers have direct access to the **Center for Bread Flavour** in St. Vith, Belgium, which houses the **Sourdough Library**.⁸ This library is a "backup of the world's bread heritage," containing over 900 strains of wild yeast.
 - *The "Digital Twin" Opportunity:* Currently, accessing this library requires physical shipment of samples. GenAI could facilitate a "Digital Twin" of the fermentation process. By sequencing the DNA of the sourdough strains and modeling their metabolic outputs (CO₂, flavor compounds), Puratos could allow a South African baker to "simulate" the flavor profile of a San Francisco sourdough using local ingredients, effectively digitizing the biological asset.

4.3 Sustainable Operations: Cacao-Trace and Beyond

Sustainability is operationalized through programs like **Cacao-Trace**, which focuses on the "post-harvest" fermentation of cocoa beans to create higher value for farmers.³⁵

- **Data Provenance:** This program generates a wealth of traceability data—from the specific farmer community to the fermentation center to the final chocolate bar.
- **Operational Integration:** The "Chocolate Bonus" (an extra payment to farmers per kg

sold) requires rigorous tracking.³⁵ GenAI can audit this flow, detecting anomalies and ensuring the integrity of the "fair payment" claim, which is a critical marketing claim for premium customers.

5. Digital Maturity Audit

Before proposing a leap into Generative AI, we must audit the firm's current digital maturity. Chipkins Puratos is not a digital novice; it possesses a robust, albeit siloed, technological foundation.

5.1 The ERP Backbone: SAP S/4HANA

The organization has undertaken a migration to **SAP S/4HANA**, the latest generation of SAP's enterprise resource planning suite.⁴¹

- **The Significance of S/4HANA:** Unlike older ERPs, S/4HANA runs on an in-memory database, allowing for real-time data processing. It serves as the "single source of truth" for finance, sales, inventory, and production data.
- **The AI Readiness:** This is a massive enabler. GenAI models struggle with unstructured, messy data. S/4HANA provides the structured, high-quality data schema that AI needs. It enables complex queries like "Correlate our cocoa procurement costs with our chocolate muffin sales volume in KZN over the last 24 months," which can be answered in seconds rather than days.

5.2 The Digital Customer Interface: MyPuratos

MyPuratos is the company's B2B e-commerce portal, designed to facilitate 24/7 ordering for professionals.¹²

- **Current Capabilities:** The platform allows customers to view catalogs, place orders, access invoices, and see basic recipe inspiration. It effectively digitizes the *transaction*.
- **The Limitation:** It acts primarily as a "self-service" portal rather than an "intelligent assistant." It waits for the customer to know what they want.
- **The Opportunity:** *MyPuratos* is the perfect delivery vehicle for GenAI. By embedding a "Smart Concierge" into the app, the interface can shift from reactive (taking orders) to proactive (suggesting orders).

5.3 The Data Jewel: Taste Tomorrow

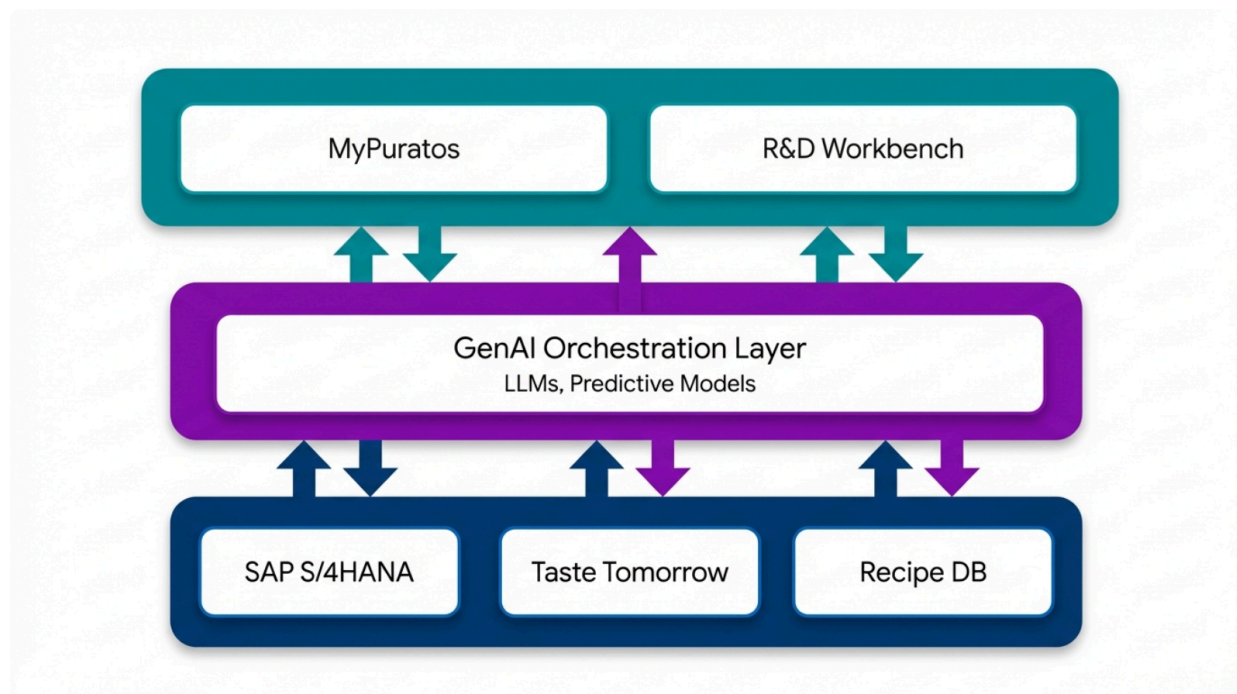
Taste Tomorrow is arguably the company's most valuable unique data asset. It is the world's largest consumer survey in bakery, patisserie, and chocolate, combining interviews with 20,000+ consumers across 50 countries (including South Africa) with "always-on" semantic AI analysis of social media and search trends.⁵

- **The Semantic AI Engine:** Puratos already uses AI to *gather* this intelligence. The system

scans millions of online conversations to identify emerging trends (e.g., "Gut Health," "Plant Forward," "Sourdough").⁶

- **The Execution Gap:** Currently, these insights are packaged into reports and presentations.¹ They are high-level and strategic. The gap lies in operationalizing them. A baker in Soweto doesn't need a PDF report on "Global Sourdough Trends"; they need a specific recipe for a sourdough loaf that can be sold for R15 and a WhatsApp flyer to advertise it. GenAI can bridge this gap by *generating* the recipe and the flyer based on the *Taste Tomorrow* data.

Proposed GenAI Architecture: The Integration Layer



The GenAI layer acts as the intelligence bridge, ingesting structured data from SAP and unstructured insights from Taste Tomorrow to power intelligent features in MyPuratos and R&D tools.

6. The Generative AI Strategic Framework

Based on the analysis of the corporate DNA, market pressures, and digital maturity, we propose a strategic framework built on four pillars. These are not abstract concepts but

specific, actionable use cases tailored to Chipkins Puratos.

Pillar 1: Intelligent Commercial Engines (Hyper-Personalization)

The Challenge: Chipkins Puratos serves a fragmented market—from massive industrial plant bakeries to small "home industry" entrepreneurs. A human sales force cannot adequately service the "long tail" of smaller customers with personalized advice.

The GenAI Solution: The "MyPuratos" Smart Concierge.

- **Mechanism:** Deploy a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) system integrated into the *MyPuratos* app. This agent would have access to three datasets: the customer's purchase history (SAP), the full product catalog (PIM), and the *Taste Tomorrow* trend database.
- **User Story:** A mid-sized bakery owner in Durban logs in. The AI recognizes they haven't ordered "Easter bun spice" yet, despite Easter being 4 weeks away. It proactively messages: *"Hi Sarah, Easter is approaching! Based on last year, you usually order 50kg of Spice Mix by now. Also, 'Citrus Glazed' buns are trending in KZN this month—would you like to add our Sunset Glaze to your order to try a new recipe?"*
- **Value:** This moves the relationship from transactional to consultative, increasing "Share of Wallet" and preventing churn to cheaper competitors like RCL Foods.

Pillar 2: Generative R&D (Accelerated Formulation)

The Challenge: Developing new bakery products is scientifically complex. Balancing "clean label" requirements (removing E-numbers) with texture and shelf-life often requires months of trial and error in the Innovation Centers.

The GenAI Solution: Generative Recipe Formulation.

- **Mechanism:** Train a specialized model on the corpus of 320+ validated recipes⁴⁵ and the chemical functionality of Puratos ingredients (e.g., how "Soft'r Alpaga" enzymes affect gluten networks).
- **User Story:** An industrial customer requests a "Lower Sugar Chocolate Muffin" to meet new health regulations. Instead of a technical advisor physically baking 20 variations, the AI simulates the formulations. It predicts: *"Reducing sugar by 20% will decrease moisture retention. Suggest adding 0.5% 'Acti-Fresh' enzyme to compensate."* It outputs the top 3 statistically probable recipes for physical testing.
- **Value:** This significantly compresses Time-to-Market (TTM). As shown in industry benchmarks, AI-augmented R&D can reduce development cycles by up to 40%. This agility is crucial for capturing fleeting consumer trends identified by *Taste Tomorrow*.

Pillar 3: Cognitive Supply Chain (Resilience & Prediction)

The Challenge: The volatility of the South African supply chain (power, ports, currency) makes static planning obsolete. "Just-in-Time" becomes "Just-too-Late."

The GenAI Solution: Predictive Risk & Inventory Modeling.

- **Mechanism:** An AI agent that layers external risk data (weather patterns affecting cocoa harvests, Transnet port delay reports, Eskom load-shedding schedules) over internal SAP inventory data.
- **User Story:** The system detects a severe drought forecast in West Africa (threatening cocoa) and simultaneous congestion at Durban port. It alerts the Supply Chain Director: *"High risk of Cocoa Powder stock-out in Month 3. Recommendation: Increase safety stock of 'Belcolade' chocolate buttons by 15% immediately, using the Cape Town warehouse which has lower congestion."*
- **Value:** Protecting the "wet and dry" lines from stoppage. Ensuring that high-margin customers never face a stock-out of critical ingredients.

Pillar 4: Institutional Knowledge Preservation (The AI Tutor)

The Challenge: Technical baking knowledge is "tribal." It resides in the heads of senior technical advisors. When they retire, that expertise leaves. Furthermore, the Bakery School Foundation needs to scale its educational impact with limited resources.

The GenAI Solution: The "Baker's Brain" Trust.

- **Mechanism:** Ingest all technical manuals, troubleshooting guides, Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs), and educational curricula into a private, secure Large Language Model (LLM).
- **User Story:** A junior sales rep is on-site at a bakery. The customer asks, *"My custard is weeping (syneresis) after 2 days. Why?"* The rep queries the AI app, which synthesizes 20 years of Puratos technical data to answer: *"Syneresis in custard is often caused by over-cooking the starch or low pH. Check if they are adding acidic fruit too early. Recommend switching to 'Cremyvite' which has higher acid stability."*
- **Value:** Immediate upskilling of the workforce, consistent technical advice across all regions, and democratization of the Bakery School curriculum to students via WhatsApp.

7. Implementation Roadmap & Change Management

Implementing GenAI is as much a cultural challenge as a technical one, particularly in a decentralized environment like Bidcorp. We recommend a phased "Crawl, Walk, Run" approach.

Phase 1: The Foundation (Months 1-4)

- **Focus:** Data Governance & Internal Tools.
- **Action:** Audit the data quality in SAP S/4HANA. "Clean data is the fuel for AI."
- **Pilot:** Launch the internal "**Baker's Brain**" knowledge bot for the sales team. This is a low-risk, high-utility tool that proves the value of AI to the staff without exposing it to

customers yet.

- **Talent:** Appoint a "Head of AI Strategy" to bridge the gap between IT (Bidcorp) and Innovation (Puratos).

Phase 2: The Pilot (Months 5-9)

- **Focus:** External Value Generation.
- **Action:** Integrate the **"MyPuratos" Smart Concierge** for a select group of "friendly" retail customers. Test the recommendation algorithms.
- **Project:** Initiate the **Generative R&D** pilot in one Innovation Center (e.g., Edenvale), focusing on a specific category like "Gluten-Free" to test recipe simulation.

Phase 3: The Scale-Up (Months 10-18)

- **Focus:** Integration & Automation.
- **Action:** Roll out the Smart Concierge to the full customer base. Connect the **Predictive Supply Chain** module to live procurement systems.
- **Integration:** Ensure that insights from *Taste Tomorrow* are automatically feeding into the sales suggestions in *MyPuratos* without human intervention.

8. Conclusion

Chipkins Puratos stands on a solid foundation. The joint venture structure has successfully married the logistical prowess of Bidcorp with the innovative spirit of Puratos, creating a market leader that is resilient and profitable. However, the market is evolving. Competitors are aggressive, infrastructure is fragile, and customers are demanding more than just ingredients—they are demanding intelligence.

Generative AI offers the strategic lever to secure the next decade of growth. It is the tool that transforms the "wet and dry" manufacturing lines into "smart" production systems. It transforms *MyPuratos* from an ordering portal into a digital partner. It transforms *Taste Tomorrow* from a report into a revenue engine.

By adopting this GenAI strategy, Chipkins Puratos will not only optimize its operations (appealing to Bidcorp) but also revolutionize its customer value proposition (appealing to Puratos). It is the ultimate synthesis of the JV's dual DNA, positioning the company not just as a supplier of yeast and flour, but as the architect of the future of African bakery. The "Future of Bread" is data-driven, and Chipkins Puratos is uniquely qualified to bake it.

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